



◀ APPLE IPAD (3RD GENERATION)

Price: ₹30,500



iBerry AUXUS AX02, which performed really well during the tests. Aakash Tablet was launched amidst much fanfare by Union Minister Kapil Sibal, but the project didn't do well in many regards. Many of the pre-orders were not fulfilled, and the tablets themselves had quality issues. The Aakash II project has successfully commenced, with the recent launch of the tablet. Budget tablet makers are crying foul over the price of the Aakash tablet, which will undercut them massively.

Zero1 Winner

Apple iPad (3rd Generation)

The best tablet in the market just got better. Just to get the timelines right, the 4th generation has also been released globally, along with the iPad Mini, but that is still to be available in India officially. A faster processor, more RAM, more powerful graphics and the Retina display makes the iPad the tablet to own. The moment the rivals come close, Apple just moves the benchmark further. The new iPad is slightly thicker and heavier than the iPad 2.

Worthy Mentions

Samsung Galaxy Note 800

From Android's side, the one that gives the iPad some competition is the Samsung Galaxy Note 800. This is the best Android tablet in terms of performance, and pips the ASUS Transformer Prime, which was the leader till then. Apart from the quad-core processor, the aspect that makes the difference is 2 GB of RAM, which should be the norm going forward, for high-end Android tablets. Excellent display and all the Galaxy Note II phablet's S-Pen capabilities are now also on the full-fledged tablet. The only niggle is its plasticky build. Must consider, if you want the very best Android tablet out there.

ASUS Transformer Prime

Its predecessor showed us another side of tablets and the Transformer Prime built on that brilliantly. This was the first quad-core processor powered Android tablet. But the real USP was its full-fledged keyboard dock that offered connectivity options for USB devices and an extra battery pack. Rather expensive, but then again, this is the tablet that comes close to offering the convenience of a netbook's keyboard when you need it urgently. It also offers good display and excellent battery life.

Tablets

As far as big players went, apart from the usual Apple vs. Samsung battle, both on the shop floor and in the courtroom, the other tablet makers, such as Acer, Motorola and HTC were rather silent for the major part of the year. The much-expected HTC fight-back after the Flyer didn't materialise. Blackberry's PlayBook with 3G capabilities launched in some countries, but hasn't reached India yet. Same with Sony's Xperia tablet, which was launched amidst much excitement in the U.S., but some build quality issues halted its march rather prematurely.

ASUS gave us the amazing follow-up to the brilliant Transformer. Apple, uncharacteristically, launched three tablets – the third generation iPad, the iPad Mini and simultaneously the fourth generation iPad. Samsung launched a few tablets, but the Note 800 was the most exciting.

In the Indian market, the budget tablet segment was abuzz with activity. That proved to be the real boost the market needed to get the tablet as a device on to the consumers' radar. The price range for these tablets was between ₹5,000 and ₹15,000. Some of the more popular ones to come out of the crowd include the Micromax FunBook Pro, the Zync Z990 and the



Samsung Galaxy Note 800

Price: ₹37,500



ASUS Transformer Prime

Price: ₹46,010